Jinxin Wu

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics 2021 - 2027 (expected)
Georgetown University, Department of Economics Washington, DC

M.A. in International Economics 2015 – 2017
Johns Hopkins University, School of Advanced International Studies Washington, DC

B.A. in Journalism 2006 – 2010
Fudan University Shanghai, China

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Macroeconomics, Public Finance

Secondary: Quantitative Macroeconomics, Fiscal Policy, Taxation

WORKING PAPERS

Optimal Defense Spending and Taxation Under Stochastic Threat *Job Market Paper*

This paper studies optimal defense spending and taxation in a dynamic economy in which public spending protects productive capital from destruction. Because the same capital stock can also be taxed to finance its protection, productive investment and protective investment are closely linked. The model implies that defense spending increases with destruction exposure when protection is active. When defense technology is sufficiently effective, greater destruction exposure can induce more protection and investment, allowing capital and output to recover, although this adaptation is costly. A Ramsey government can partially reproduce this response. Under discretion, anticipated taxation of installed capital reduces private investment, shrinks the capital base, and weakens defense. In the baseline calibration, lack of commitment generates a 2.25 percent consumption-equivalent welfare loss, and this loss increases with destruction exposure. The findings highlight the importance of fiscal institutions and policy credibility when the assets being protected are also an important source of tax revenue.

Propagation of Macroeconomic Shocks Through Input-Output and Geographic Networks in China (with Ergys Islamaj)

We study how sector-specific demand and supply shocks propagate through China's input-output and regional networks. Indirect network effects account for a substantial share of aggregate fluctuations, with inter-sectoral linkages representing roughly 30 percent of economic activity. The results highlight the central role of manufacturing and production networks in amplifying shocks across sectors and regions. The framework provides a tool for assessing the economy-wide impact of trade, productivity, and other sector-specific shocks.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Temporary Spending or Lasting Growth? Government Procurement and Human Capital

This paper studies how the effectiveness of government spending varies across local economies. Matching granular U.S. defense procurement data and county-level labor market outcomes, I try to estimate local fiscal effects and examine how spending composition shapes economic performance. Preliminary results suggest that

technology-intensive procurement generates more persistent employment and income gains. The findings highlight the role of local absorptive capacity and human capital accumulation in fiscal transmission.

Effects of Elite Colleges Expanding Free Tuition (with Mihyun You)

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Georgetown University 2022–2024
Research Assistant to Prof. Toshihiko Mukoyama Washington, DC

- Constructed a firm-establishment-level panel dataset from multiple large-scale administrative datasets.

Research Assistant to Prof. Xiang Ding

- Assisted in compiling a global dataset on inter-sectoral capital service expenditures, enabling the construction of the first global input-output matrix of capital services.

The World Bank Group 2017–2021
Research Analyst, Prospects Group Washington, DC
Won VPU Team Award, 2021 and 2022

- Developed forecasting models and provided analysis in flagship report *Global Economic Prospects* and *Commodity Markets Outlook*.
- Contributed to research on global debt waves, commodity markets, production networks, and informal economy.

The Financial Times 2010–2014
Researcher, FT Confidential Research Shanghai, China

- Researched and wrote on China's economic reforms, financial regulations, and capital market.

POLICY PUBLICATIONS

- "Propagation of Macroeconomic Shocks Through Input-Output and Geographic Networks in China," in *East Asia and Pacific Economic Update*, World Bank, April 2019, with Ergys Islamaj and Francesca de Nicola.
- "Informal Economy in East Asia and Pacific," in *Global Economic Prospects*, World Bank, January 2019.
- "Spillovers to Developing East Asia and Pacific from China," in *East Asia and Pacific Economic Update*, World Bank, October 2018, with Ergys Islamaj and Ekaterine T. Vashakmadze.
- "Raw material commodity prices gain momentum amid stronger demand," World Bank, December 2020.
- "Beverage commodity prices to stabilize amid stronger demand and ample supplies," World Bank, December 2020.
- "Global food commodity prices in a post-COVID world," World Bank, November 2020.
- "Food prices to edge up in 2019 but energy, trade, and foreign exchange could unsettle outlook," World Bank.
- "Beverage prices weak on good crops and currency movements," World Bank.
- "Raw materials outlook: Cotton, rubber prices to stabilize in 2019," World Bank.
- "Food prices: Markets are well-supplied, but trade tensions, energy prices, and an Africa Swine Fever outbreak could create market instability," World Bank.
- "Raw material prices to stabilize in 2019, make gains in 2020," World Bank.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Georgetown University

Instructor 2024 Summer (5/5, evaluation), 2025 Summer
Intermediate Macroeconomics

Graduate Teaching Assistant 2022–2026
International Finance; Intermediate Macroeconomics; Introduction to Econometrics; International Trade; Economic Analysis of Law

AWARDS

Graduate School Fellowship, Georgetown University	2021–2026
Department of Economics Summer Research Fellowship, Georgetown University	Summer 2024
National Merit Scholarship, Fudan University	2009
Tsang Hin Chi Scholarship, Fudan University	2009
Freshman Merit Scholarship, Fudan University	2006

PRESENTATIONS AND WORKSHOPS

NTA 119th Annual Conference on Taxation	2026*
Macroeconomics Seminar at Georgetown University	2026
5th Annual Macro Meetings at Georgetown (AMMEEGO) Conference	2025
Macroeconomics workshops at Georgetown University	2023–2026

SERVICE AND SKILLS

Co-chair, Economics Graduate Student Organization 2024–2025

Computation: MATLAB, Python, R, Stata, EViews

Languages: Chinese (native), English (professional fluency)

REFERENCES

Toshihiko Mukoyama, co-advisor
Professor, Department of Economics
Georgetown University
tm1309@georgetown.edu

Axel Anderson, co-advisor
Professor, Department of Economics
Georgetown University
aza@georgetown.edu

Joshua Teitelbaum
David Belding Professor of Law, Law Center
Professor of Economics, Department of Economics
Georgetown University
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